

Fine Motor Activities

Little hands grow strong through play — a few minutes a day is plenty.

CHILD _____

AGE _____

Pick a few activities that match your child's stage, then check them off as you try them together.

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Everyday Fine-Motor Helpers

build strong hands during daily routines

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Peel a banana or clementine at snack time | ☐ Zip, button & snap their own coat |
| ☐ Squeeze a sponge or washcloth in the bath | ☐ Open snack packages, lids & containers |
| ☐ Tear lettuce or snap green beans for dinner | ☐ Spray & water plants with a small bottle |
| ☐ Wind up toys, turn keys & twist knobs | ☐ Pick up toys with kitchen tongs (make it a game) |

Baby & Early Toddler

6–18 months

- ☐ Pincer-grasp puffs & soft cereal
- ☐ Drop objects into a bin, then dump & refill
- ☐ Stack 2–3 soft blocks
- ☐ Pull scarves from a tissue box
- ☐ Turn thick board-book pages
- ☐ Bang two blocks or cups together

Toddler

18 months–3 years

- ☐ Stack a tower of 4–6 blocks
- ☐ Scribble & dot with chunky crayons
- ☐ Post coins or pom-poms through a slot
- ☐ Peel & stick large stickers
- ☐ Roll, poke & squish playdough
- ☐ Feed self with a spoon or fork

Preschooler

3–4 years

- ☐ Thread large beads onto a shoelace
- ☐ Snip paper with safety scissors
- ☐ Move pom-poms with tongs or tweezers
- ☐ Build with interlocking bricks
- ☐ Complete inset & peg puzzles
- ☐ Trace straight lines, circles & zig-zags

Pre-K & Kindergarten

4–6 years

- ☐ Cut along curved & zig-zag lines
- ☐ Hold a pencil with a tripod grip
- ☐ Lace cards & tie simple knots
- ☐ Button, zip & snap independently
- ☐ Draw a person with 6+ body parts
- ☐ Copy letters, numbers & their name

There's no rush and no "behind." Fine motor skills grow with playful, everyday practice — follow your child's lead and keep it light and fun.

Weekly Practice Tracker

Aim for a little each day — check a box every time you practice a skill.

WEEK OF _____

MINUTES/DAY _____

Tick off the days you practice each skill. Even five focused minutes counts — consistency beats length.

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Skill to Practice	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Pinch & grasp <i>puffs, pom-poms, clothespins</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Cutting <i>safety scissors & scrap paper</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Drawing, coloring & tracing <i>crayons, markers, lines</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Threading & lacing <i>beads, buttons, lacing cards</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Building & stacking <i>blocks, cups, bricks</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Playdough & squeezing <i>roll, pinch, poke, squish</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Self-care skills <i>buttons, zips, spoon, laces</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Watch for These Wins	<i>celebrate as they emerge</i>
☐ Uses a neat pincer grasp (thumb + finger)	
☐ Stacks a small tower without toppling	
☐ Snips paper & cuts a straight line	
☐ Holds a crayon with a tripod grip	
☐ Threads beads onto a lace	
☐ Copies shapes & first letters	

Busy-Hands Basket	<i>keep these on hand</i>
☐ Chunky crayons & washable markers	
☐ Safety scissors & scrap paper	
☐ Playdough or modeling clay	
☐ Large beads, buttons & shoelaces	
☐ Pom-poms, tongs & tweezers	
☐ Stacking cups, blocks & stickers	

Notes — what we loved & what to try next

DAYS PRACTICED _____

SKILLS TRIED _____

TOTAL MINUTES _____

FAVORITE ACTIVITY _____